

Object-oriented Programming

Week 9 | Lecture 1&2

default arguments in c++

- A default argument is a value provided in a function declaration that is automatically assigned by the compiler if the caller of the function doesn't provide a value for the argument with a default value.

Rule 1

- Default arguments must be the rightmost (trailing) arguments in a function's parameter list. default arguments are assigned from right to left
- Once we provide a default value for a parameter, all subsequent parameters must also have default values. For example,

- `// Invalid`
- `void add(int a, int b = 3, int c, int d);`
- `// Invalid`
- `void add(int a, int b = 3, int c, int d = 4);`
- `// Valid`
- `void add(int a, int c, int b = 3, int d = 4);`

Rule 2

- If we are defining the default arguments in the function definition instead of the function prototype, then the function must be defined before the function call.

- `// Invalid code`
- `int main() {`
- `// function call`
- `display();`
- `}`
- `void display(char c = '*', int count = 5) {`
- `// code`
- `}`

Operator Overloading

- C++ allows you to specify more than one definition for an operator in the same scope, which is called operator overloading.
- You can redefine or overload most of the built-in operators available in C++
- It is a type of polymorphism in which an operator is overloaded to give user defined meaning to it.

Operator Overloading

- Defining a new behavior for common operators of a language
- C++ enables you to overload most operators to be sensitive to the context in which they're used
- Using operator overloading makes a program clearer than accomplishing the same operations with function calls

when operators are overloaded as member functions, they must be non-static

- When operators are overloaded as **member functions**, they must be **non-static** because they operate on **instances** of a class

Static Functions Do Not Have this

- A static function does not have access to this, meaning it cannot directly access instance variables.
- Since operator overloading usually involves modifying or accessing object attributes, a static function would not work properly.

Operator Overloading

- An operator is overloaded by writing a non-static member function definition or global function definition
- To use an operator on class objects (as operands), that operator **“must” be overloaded**

Operator Overloading

- Operator overloading cannot change the arity of an operator
- Operator overloading works when *at least* one argument of that operator is an object
- We cannot create new operators using operator overloading

LIST OF OPERATORS THAT CAN'T BE OVERLOADED

- Almost any operator can be overloaded in C++. However there are few operator which can not be overloaded.
- scope operator (::)
- sizeof
- member selector –(.)
- member pointer selector – (.*)
- ternary operator – (?:)

BUILT IN OVERLOADS

- Most operators are already overloaded for fundamental types.
- Example:
- 1) In the case of the expression:
- a / b the operand type determines the machine code created by the compiler for the division operator. If both operands are integral types, an integral division is performed;
- in all other cases floating-point division occurs. Thus, different actions are performed depending on the operand types involved.
- 2) $<<$, which is used both as the stream insertion operator and as the bitwise left-shift operator.

Works fine

- `#include <iostream>`
- `using namespace std;`
- `int main() {`
- `int a=5;`
- `int b=3;`
- `int z=a+b;`
- `cout << z;`
- `return 0;}`

Output?

- `#include <iostream>`
- `using namespace std;`
- `class Complex {`
- `private:`
- `int real;`
- `int image;`
- `public:`
- `Complex(){`
- `real = 0;`
- `image = 0; }`
- `Complex(int r, int i){`
- `real = r;`
- `image = i;}`

Output?

- ```
void displayComplex() {
 cout << "real: " << real << " Imaginary:" << image
 << endl; }
}
```

```
int main() {
 Complex c1(2,1);
 Complex c2(3,1);
 Complex c3;
 c3=c1+c2;
 return 0;}
```



# Output

- [Error] no match for 'operator+' (operand types are 'Complex' and 'Complex')

# criteria/rules to define the operator function:

- In case of a non-static function, the binary operator should have only one argument and unary should not have an argument.

# Syntax of Operator Overloading

- Return type operator op(argument list);
- return\_type class\_name :: operator op(argument\_list)
- {
- // function body
- }

# Example of Operator Overloading

```
class Complex {
 private:
 int real;
 int image;
 public:
 Complex(){
 real = 0;
 image = 0; }
 Complex(int r, int i){
 real = r;
 image = i;}
```

# Example of Operator Overloading

```
void displayComplex() {
 cout << "real: " << real << " Imaginary:" << image
 << endl; }
// overloaded (+) operator
Complex operator+ (Complex c) {
 Complex temp;
 temp.real=real+c.real;
 temp.image=image+c.image;
 return temp;
};
```

# Example of Operator Overloading

```
int main() {
 Complex c1(2,1);
 Complex c2(3,1);
 Complex c3;
 c3 = c1.operator+ (c2);
 //c3=c1+c2;
 c3.displayComplex();
 return 0;}

```

- `c3=c1+c2; // statement 1`
- It is same like
- `c3=c1.add(c2);` just for understanding
- In statement 1, Left object `c1` will invoke `operator+()` function and right object `c2` is passing as an argument.
- Another way of calling binary operator overloading function is to call like a normal member function as follows,

`c3 = c1.operator+ ( c2 );`

 C:\Users\Nida Munawar\Documents\Untitled2.exe

real: 5 Imaginary:2

-----

Process exited after 0.2174 seconds with return value 0

Press any key to continue . . .



- `int main() {`
- `Complex c1(2,1);`
- `Complex c2(3,1);`
- `Complex c3(1,1);`
- `Complex c4;`
- `c4=c1+c2+c3;`
- `c4.displayComplex();`
- `return 0;}`

- $c4=c1+c2+c3;$
- Firstly addition of  $c1+c2$  happen then the result of  $c1+c2$  added to  $c3$  and stored in  $c4$  here add function called two times

 C:\Users\Nida Munawar\Documents\Untitled2.exe

real: 6 Imaginary:3

-----

Process exited after 0.3021 seconds with return value 0

Press any key to continue . . .

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;
class Binary {
 int i;
public:
 Binary(int val = 0) : i(val) {}

 // Binary + Operator Overload (returns new object)
 Binary operator+(const Binary& obj) {
 Binary temp; // Create a new object (temp)
 temp.i = this->i + obj.i;
 return temp; // Return new object (not reference)
 }

 void Display() const {
 cout << "i=" << i << endl;
 }
};
```

```
int main() {
 Binary obj1(5), obj2(3), obj3;

 obj3 = obj1 + obj2; // obj3 = obj1.operator+(obj2);
 obj3.Display(); // Output: i=8

 Binary obj4;
 obj4 = obj1 + obj2 + obj3; // Chaining works: obj4 = (obj1 + obj2) + obj3;
 //obj4 = obj1.operator+(obj2).operator+(obj3);

 obj4.Display(); // Output: i=16

 return 0;
}
```

## Step-by-Step Execution of $\text{obj1} + \text{obj2} + \text{obj3}$

### 1. First, $\text{obj1} + \text{obj2}$

- $\text{temp1.i} = \text{obj1.i} + \text{obj2.i} = 5 + 3 = 8$
- Returns a new object (temp1 with  $i=8$ ).

### 2. Then, $\text{temp1} + \text{obj3}$

- $\text{temp2.i} = \text{temp1.i} + \text{obj3.i} = 8 + 8 = 16$
- Returns another new object (temp2 with  $i=16$ ).

### 3. Assign result to $\text{obj4}$

- $\text{obj4} = \text{temp2}$
- $\text{obj4.i} = 16$

## Step-by-Step Breakdown:

1. `obj1 + obj2` → Calls `obj1.operator+(obj2)`, returns a new object (say `temp1`).

2. `temp1 + obj3` → Calls `temp1.operator+(obj3)`, returns another new object (say `temp2`).

3. `obj4 = temp2` → Assigns `temp2` to `obj4`.

# Prefix Increment (++i)

- Increments first, then returns the updated value.

```
#include <iostream>
int main() {
 int i = 5;
 int x = ++i;

 std::cout << "i = " << i << std::endl;
 std::cout << "x = " << x << std::endl;}
```



# Postfix Increment (i++)

- Returns the original value first, then increments.

```
#include <iostream>
int main() {
 int i = 5;
 int x = i++;

 std::cout << "i = " << i << std::endl;
 std::cout << "x = " << x << std::endl;
}
```

# Difference between post and prefix

- `int y=0;`
- `y=x++;`
- `cout <<x;`
- `cout<<y;`

- $X=1$
- $Y=0$
- In postfix firstly substitute the value then increment happens

# For Prefix ++ operator

```
void operator ++ ()
{
 ++x;
 ++y;
}
```

*(Works the same way for prefix decrement operator)*

# For Prefix ++ operator

- `class Prefix{`
- `int i;`
- `public:`
- `Prefix(): i(0) { }`
- `void operator ++()`
- `{ ++i; }`
- `void Display()`
- `{ cout << "i=" << i << endl; };`
- `int main(){`
- `Prefix obj;`
- `obj.Display();`
- `++obj;`
- `//you can also write obj.operator ++();`
- `obj.Display();`
- `return 0;}`

- Prefix (++obj) works by first incrementing and then returning the object.
- Returning \*this allows chaining (++(++obj)).

- class Prefix {
- int i;
- public:
- Prefix() : i(0) {}
- // Prefix increment overloading
- Prefix& operator++() { // Returning reference
- ++i;
- return \*this; // Return the updated object
- }
- void Display() {
- cout << "i=" << i << endl;
- }
- };

- `int main() {`
- `Prefix obj;`
- `obj.Display(); // i = 0`
- `++obj; // Calls operator++()`
- `obj.Display(); // i = 1`
- `++(++obj); // Works because we return a reference`
- `// obj.operator++().operator++();`
- `obj.Display(); // i = 3`
- `return 0;`
- `}`

# execution order

This means that the execution order follows left-to-right evaluation:

1. `obj.operator++()` → modifies `obj` (increases value by 1)
2. `obj.operator++()` (on the modified `obj`) → modifies `obj` again (increases value by 1 more)



# Output?

- `#include <iostream>`
- `class Number {`
- `int value;`
- `public:`
- `Number(int v) : value(v) {}`
- `Number(){}`
- `Number operator++() {`
- `Number z;`
- `z= ++value;`
- `return z; }`
- `void display() const {`
- `std::cout << "Current Value: " << value << std::endl;`
- `};`

- `int main() {`
- `Number obj(5);`
- `obj.display();`
- `Number o;`
- `o=++(++obj); //obj.operator++().operator++();`
- `obj.display();`
- `o .display();//effects on z object`
- `return 0;`
- `}`

```
Current Value: 5
Current Value: 6
Current Value: 7

Process exited after 0.3459 seconds with return value 0
Press any key to continue . . .
```

# distinguish between post and prefix

- The operator symbol for both **prefix(++i)** and **postfix(i++)** are the same. Hence, we need two different function definitions to distinguish between them. This is achieved by passing a dummy int parameter in the postfix version.

# For Postfix ++ Operator

```
#include<iostream>
using namespace std;
class Postfix{
 int i;
public:
 Postfix(): i(0) { }
 void operator ++(int)
 { i++; }
 void Display()
 { cout << "i=" << i << endl; };
```

```
int main(){
 Postfix obj;
 obj.Display();
 obj.operator ++(4); //for this syntax you
must have to pass a dummy value
 // you can also write obj++;
 obj.Display();
 return 0;}
```

C:\Users\Nida\Documents\Untitled1.exe

i=0

i=1

-----

Process exited after 1.981 seconds with return value 0

Press any key to continue . . .

# It should return old value as postfix rules

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;
class Postfix {
 int i;
public:
 Postfix() : i(0) { }
 Postfix operator++(int) {
 Postfix temp = *this; // Store current state
 i++; // Increment current object
 return temp; // Return old state
 }

 void Display() {
 cout << "i = " << i << endl;
 }
};
```



# Correct code for postfix

```
int main() {
 Postfix obj;
 obj.Display();

 Postfix obj2 = obj++;
 obj.Display();
 obj2.Display(); // Should still hold old value

 return 0;
}
```

- Prefix (`++obj`) allows chaining because it returns `*this` (a reference).
- Postfix (`obj++`) cannot allow chaining because it must return a temporary copy.

Since `temp` is a local object, it gets destroyed after the function returns.

So, if we write:

```
obj++.operator++();
```

This will not compile, because `obj++` returns a temporary object, and we cannot modify a temporary object.

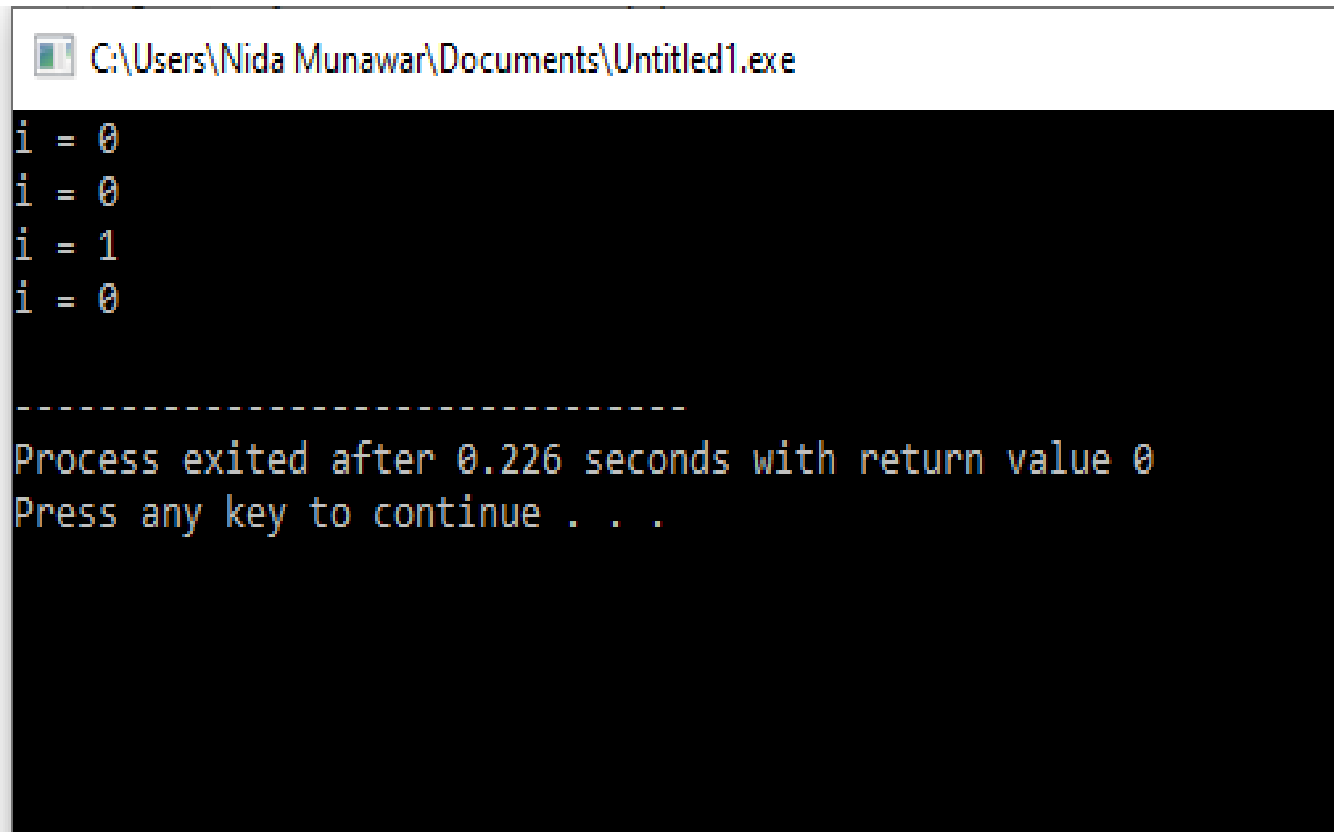
# Output?

- class Check{
- int i;
- public:
- Check(): i(0) { }
- Check operator ++ (int){
- Check temp;
- temp.i = i++;
- return temp;}
- void Display()
- { cout << "i = " << i << endl; } };

# Output?

- `int main(){`
- `Check obj, obj1;`
- `obj.Display();`
- `obj1.Display();`
- `obj1 = obj++;`
- `obj.Display();`
- `obj1.Display();`
- `return 0;}`

# Output



```
C:\Users\Nida Munawar\Documents\Untitled1.exe
i = 0
i = 0
i = 1
i = 0

Process exited after 0.226 seconds with return value 0
Press any key to continue . . .
```

# Why Not return \*this; in Postfix?

- `#include <iostream>`
- `using namespace std;`
- `class Postfix {`
- `int i;`
- `public:`
- `Postfix() : i(0) { }`
- `Postfix& operator++(int) {`
- `i++; // Increment first`
- `return *this; }`
- `void Display() {`
- `cout << "i = " << i << endl;`
- `}`
- `};`

- `int main() {`
- `Postfix obj;`
- `obj.Display();`
- `Postfix obj2 = obj++;`
- `obj.Display();`
- `obj2.Display();`
- `return 0;`
- `}`

D:\fall 2024\OneDrive\Docum X

+

▼

```
i = 0
i = 1
i = 1
```

```

Process exited after 0.1261 seconds with return value 0
Press any key to continue . . .
```



# Restrictions on Operator Overloading

| Operators that can be overloaded |          |    |    |    |    |     |        |  |
|----------------------------------|----------|----|----|----|----|-----|--------|--|
| +                                | -        | *  | /  | %  | ^  | &   |        |  |
| ~                                | !        | =  | <  | >  | += | -=  | *=     |  |
| /=                               | %=       | ^= | &= | =  | << | >>  | >>=    |  |
| <<=                              | ==       | != | <= | >= | && |     | ++     |  |
| --                               | ->*      | ,  | -> | [] | () | new | delete |  |
| new[]                            | delete[] |    |    |    |    |     |        |  |

Operators that can be overloaded.

| Operators that cannot be overloaded |    |    |    |
|-------------------------------------|----|----|----|
| .                                   | .* | :: | ?: |

Operators that cannot be overloaded.

# Assignment Operator =

The assignment operator has a signature like this:

```
class MyClass {
public:
MyClass & operator=(const MyClass &rhs);
};
int main(){
MyClass a, b; ...
b = a; // Same as b.operator=(a);
}
```

Notice that the = operator takes a const-reference to the right hand side of the assignment.

The reason for this should be obvious, since we don't want to change that value; we only want to change what's on the left hand side.

Also, you will notice that a reference is returned by the assignment operator.

This is to allow **operator chaining**. You typically see it with primitive types, like this:

# operator chaining

- **operator chaining** with primitive types, like this:
- `int a, b, c, d, e;`
- `a = b = c = d = e = 42;`
- This is interpreted by the compiler as:
- `a = (b = (c = (d = (e = 42))));`
- In other words, assignment is right-associative. The last assignment operation is evaluated first, and is propagated leftward through the series of assignments. Specifically:
- `e = 42` assigns 42 to e, then returns e as the result
- The value of e is then assigned to d, and then d is returned as the result
- The value of d is then assigned to c, and then c is returned as the result etc.

# operator chaining

- Now, in order to support operator chaining, the assignment operator must return some value. The value that should be returned is a reference to the left-hand side of the assignment.

# operator chaining with =

- `#include <iostream>`
- `using namespace std;`
- `class MyClass {`
- `private:`
- `int value; // Example member variable`
- `public:`
- `// Constructor`
- `MyClass(int val = 0) : value(val) {}`
- `MyClass& operator=(const MyClass &rhs) {`
- `this->value = rhs.value; }`
- `return *this; // Return reference to the current object`
- `}`
- `void display() const {`
- `cout << "Value: " << value << endl;`
- `}`
- `};`

- `int main() {`
- `MyClass a(10), b(20) , c(30);`
- `cout << "Before assignment:" << endl;`
- `a.display();`
- `b.display();`
- `c.display();`
- `c = b = a;`
- `cout << "After assignment:" << endl;`
- `a.display();`
- `b.display();`
- `c.display();`
- `return 0;`
- `}`

# Explanation:

`c = b = a;` // Same as `b.operator=(a)`, then `c.operator=(b)`;

1.Right-to-left evaluation:

- `b = a` → Calls `b.operator=(a)`, copying `a` into `b`.
- `c = b` → Calls `c.operator=(b)`, copying `b` (which is now equal to `a`) into `c`.

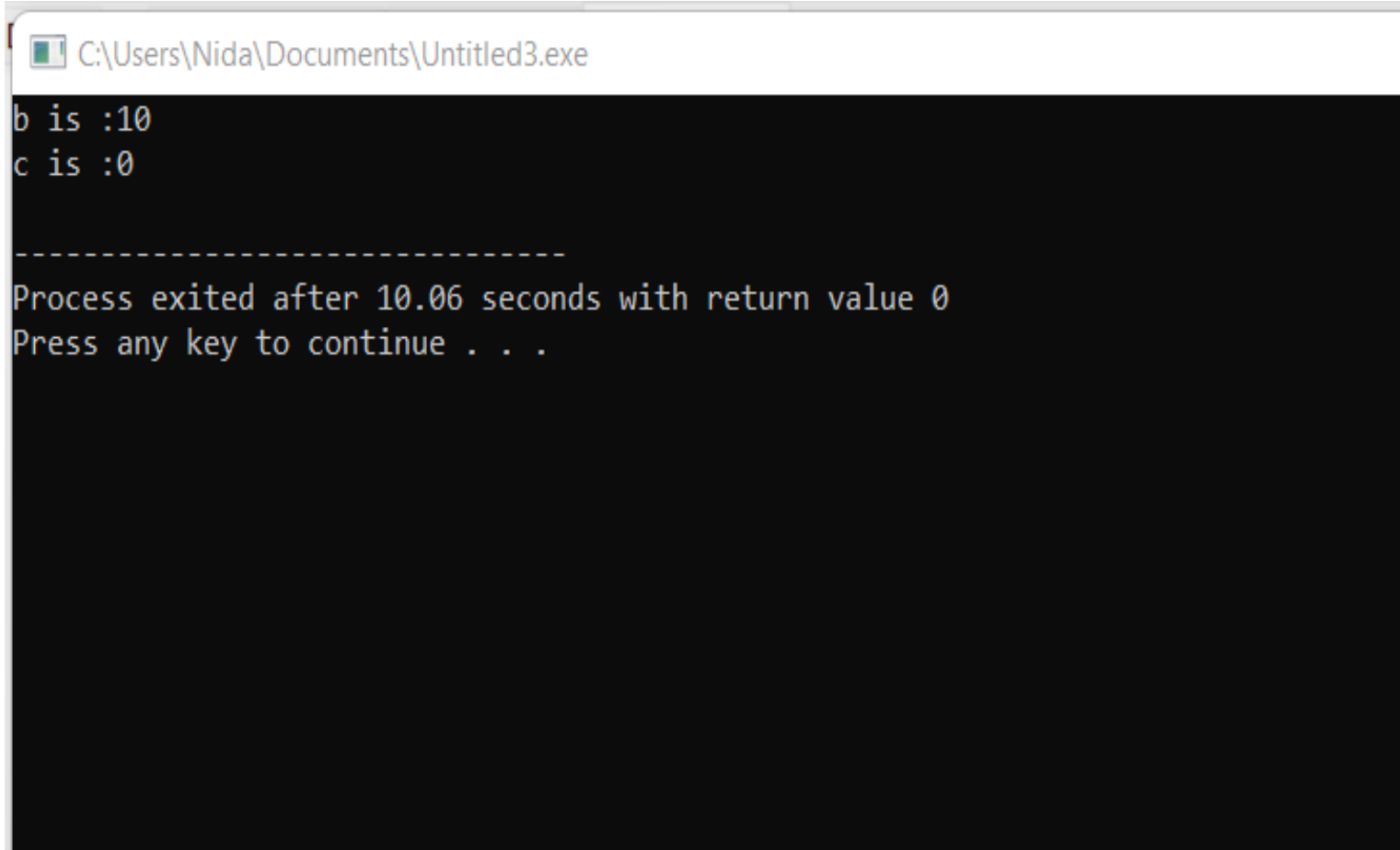
2.Since `operator=` returns `*this` (a reference to the current object), it allows chaining (`c = b = a` works as `(c = (b = a))`).



# operator chaining

- `#include<iostream>`
- `using namespace std;`
- `int main(){`
- `int a = 10 , b , c = 0;`
- `(b=c)=a;`
- `cout << "b is :" << b << endl;`
- `cout << "c is :" << c << endl;`
- `}`

# operator chaining



```
C:\Users\Nida\Documents\Untitled3.exe
b is :10
c is :0

Process exited after 10.06 seconds with return value 0
Press any key to continue . . .
```

# operator chaining

```
#include<iostream>
using namespace std;
class chain {
 private:
 int var;
 public:
 chain(){
 var = 0; }
 chain(int val){
 var = val;
 }
 void display() {
 cout << "var: " << var << endl; }
```

# operator chaining

**// overloaded (=) operator**

**chain& operator= (chain rhs) {**

**this->var=rhs.var; // this pointer is**

**optional here**

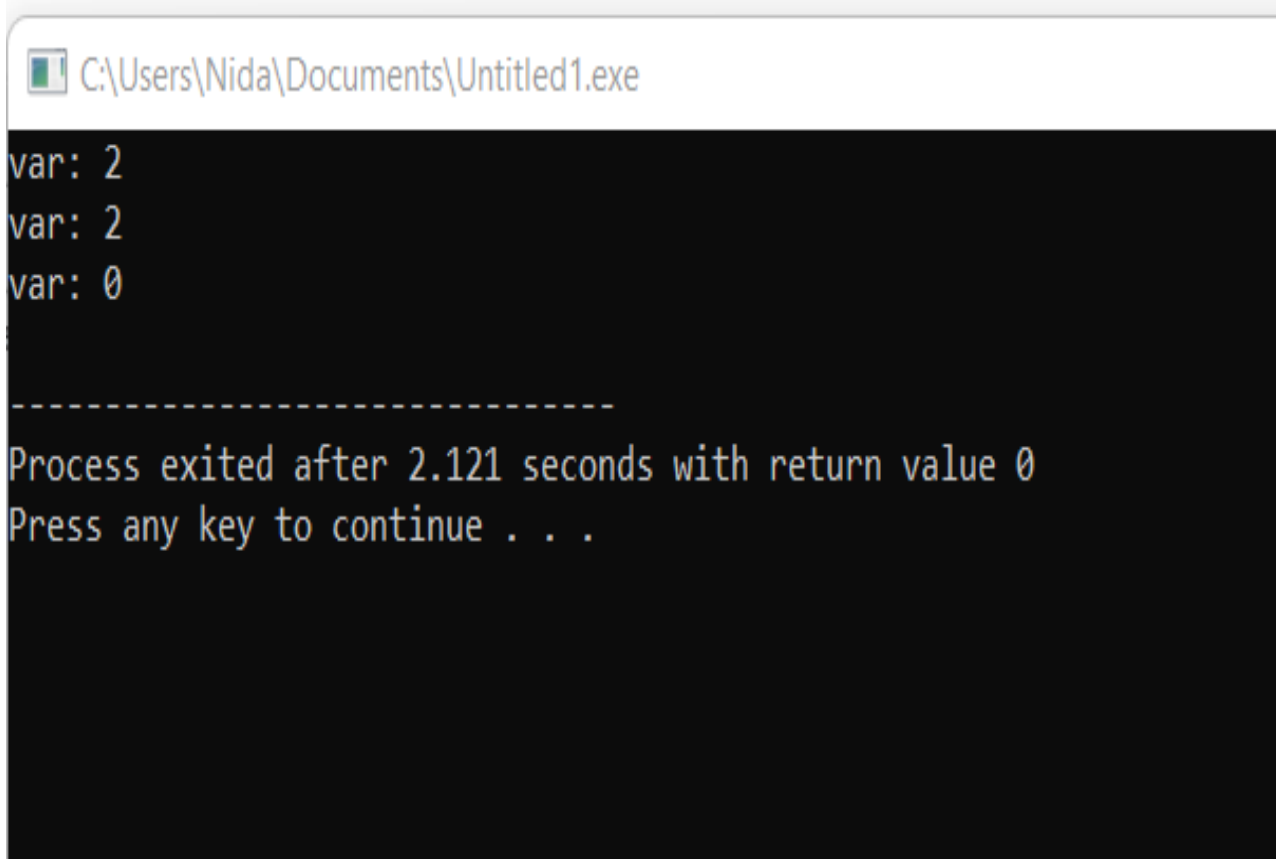
**return \*this; };**

# operator chaining

```
int main() {
 chain c1(2);
 chain c2 , c3;
 (c2=c3)=c1;
 c2.display();
 c1.display();
 c3.display();
 return 0;}
```

- Step 1:  $c2 = c3 \rightarrow c2.operator=(c3)$
- Copies  $c3.var$  into  $c2.var$ .
- Returns `*this` (which is  $c2$ ).
- Step 2:  $(c2 = c3) = c1 \rightarrow$  Now,  $c2 = c1$
- Copies  $c1.var$  into  $c2.var$ .

# operator chaining



```
C:\Users\Nida\Documents\Untitled1.exe
var: 2
var: 2
var: 0

Process exited after 2.121 seconds with return value 0
Press any key to continue . . .
```

# **operator chaining**

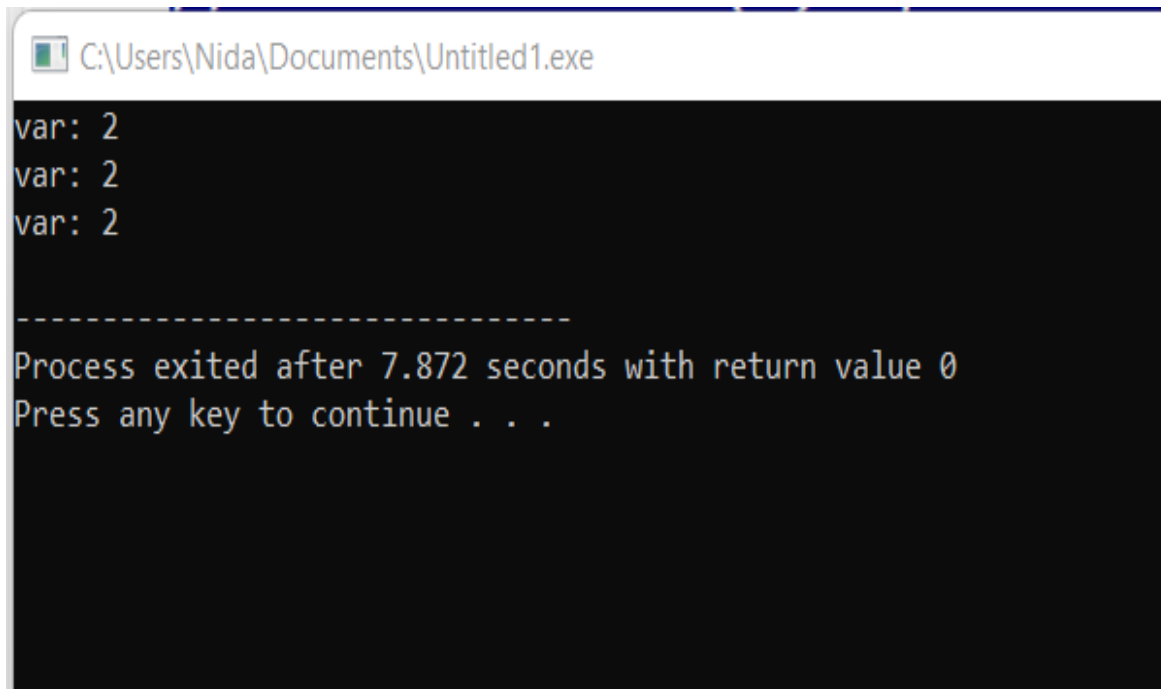
**If you are returning by value**



# Works fine when there is no parenthesis

- `// overloaded (=) operator`
- `chain operator= (chain rhs) {`
- `this->var=rhs.var; // this pointer is optional here`
- `return *this; };`
- `int main() {`
- `chain c1(2);`
- `chain c2 , c3;`
- `c2=c3=c1;`
- `c2.display();`
- `c1.display();`
- `c3.display();`
- `return 0;}`

# operator chaining



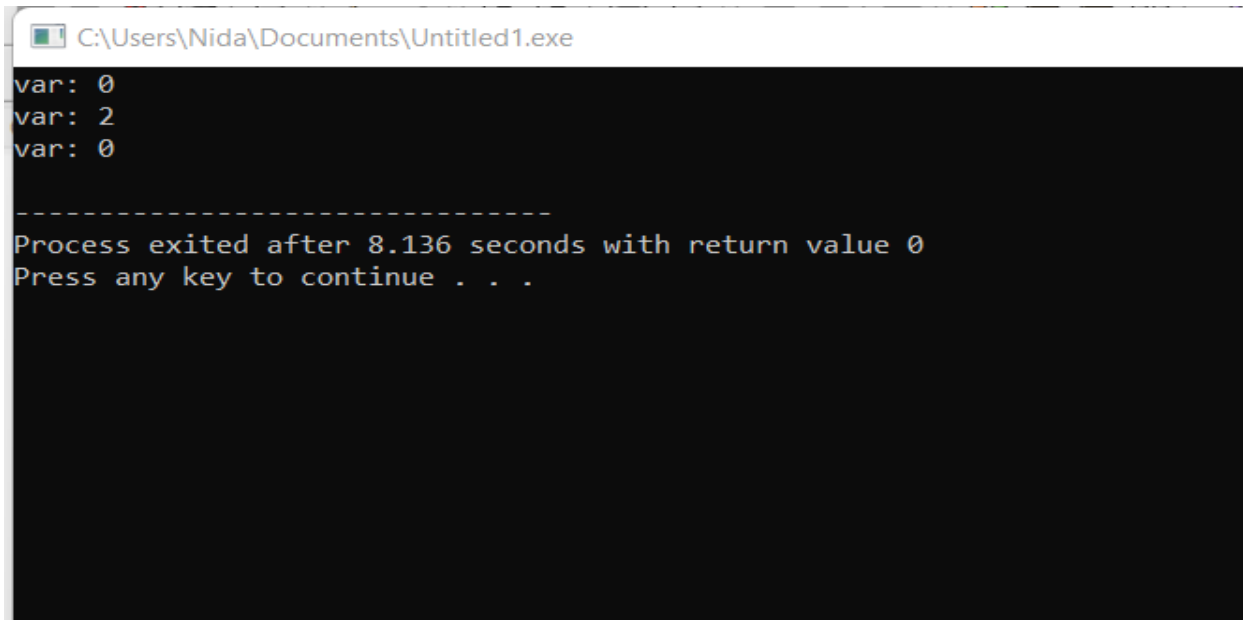
```
C:\Users\Nida\Documents\Untitled1.exe
var: 2
var: 2
var: 2

Process exited after 7.872 seconds with return value 0
Press any key to continue . . .
```

# If you are returning by value

```
chain operator= (chain rhs) {
 this->var=rhs.var;
 return *this; }
int main() {
 chain c1(2);
 chain c2 , c3;
 (c2=c3)=c1;
 c2.display();
 c1.display();
 c3.display();
 return 0;}
```

# operator chaining



```
C:\Users\Nida\Documents\Untitled1.exe
var: 0
var: 2
var: 0

Process exited after 8.136 seconds with return value 0
Press any key to continue . . .
```

Operator chaining is not possible by returning value you must return reference

# Issue: Returning by Value (chain operator=(chain rhs))

Your assignment operator is returning a copy instead of a reference.

```
(c2 = c3) = c1;
```

`c2 = c3` returns a temporary object (copy) of `c2`.

- Then, `= c1` is applied to this temporary copy, not `c2` itself.
- This means `c2` is not affected by `c1`, and its value remains from `c3`.

# In Pass by value changes only reflect inside function scope not in main

- `#include<iostream>`
- `using namespace std;`
- `class chain {`
- `private:`
- `int var;`
- `public:`
- `chain(){`
- `var = 0; }`
- `chain(int val){`
- `var = val;`
- `}`
- `void display() {`
- `cout << "var: " << var << endl; }`
- 
- `chain operator= (chain rhs) {`
- `this->var=rhs.var;`
- `cout << "inside func" << rhs.var<< endl;`
- `return *this; }`
- `};`
- `int main() {`
- `chain c1(2);`
- `chain c2 , c3;`
- `(c2=c3)=c1;`
- `c2.display();`
- `c1.display();`
- `c3.display();`
- `}`

C:\Users\Nida\Documents\Untitled1.exe

inside func0

inside func2

var: 0

var: 2

var: 0

-----

Process exited after 2.074 seconds with return value 0

Press any key to continue . . .

# operator chaining

- So, for the hypothetical MyClass assignment operator, you would do something like this:
- `// Take a const-reference to the right-hand side of the assignment.`
- `// Return a non-const reference to the left-hand side.`
- `MyClass& MyClass::operator=(const MyClass &rhs) {`
- `... // Do the assignment operation!`
- 
- `return *this; // Return a reference to myself.`
- `}`
-



# operator chaining

- Remember, this is a pointer to the object that the member function is being called on. Since `a = b` is treated as `a.operator=(b)`, you can see why it makes sense to return the object that the function is called on; object `a` is the left-hand side.
- But, the member function needs to return a reference to the object, not a pointer to the object. So, it returns `*this`, which returns what `this` points at (i.e. the object), not the pointer itself. (In C++, instances are turned into references, and vice versa, pretty much automatically, so even though `*this` is an instance, C++ implicitly converts it into a reference to the instance.)

# For += operator

```
Vector& operator += (const Vector &ob)
{
 x += ob.x;
 y += ob.y;
 return *this;
}
```

# For Unary - operator (Negation)

**Vector operator – ( ) const**

**{**

**Vector temp;**

**temp.x = -x;**

**temp.y = -y;**

**return temp;**

**}**

# Next Lecture

- Function Overriding